

orchestra when Haydn was its director. Adam's only child—named after the monastic order he had once joined—was baptized Franciscus, but became known as Franz. While still a small child, he showed a spellbinding gift as a pianist—he was remarkable for his ability to improvise at the keyboard with total fluency.

Prodigy and virtuoso

Adam Liszt took his son to study in Vienna, where the famous piano teacher Carl Czerny put his charge through a tough technical program designed to channel his natural talent. For composition, Liszt studied under Antonio Salieri.

In Vienna, Czerny took Liszt to play to Beethoven, who was as impressed as everyone else by the boy's amazing talent. The family then headed for Paris, the other great musical center of the day, where Liszt's pianism mesmerized concert audiences. His newly composed full-length opera, *Don Sanche*, was premiered there when he was just 13 years old.